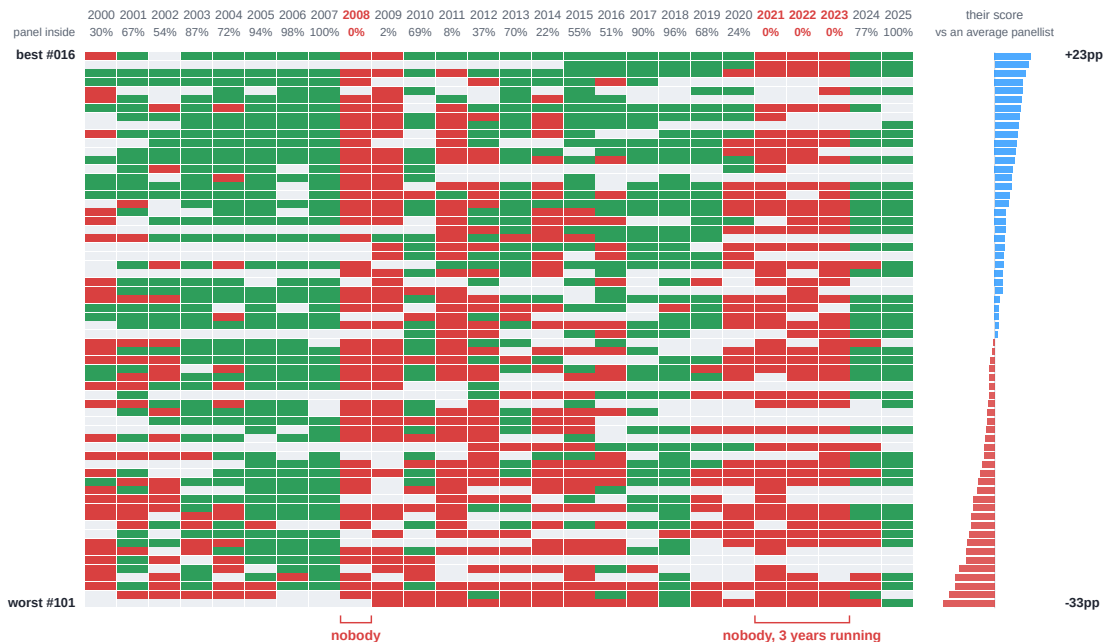


Four years when Europe's inflation forecasters **all missed together**

ECB inflation panel, 2000–2025: green = the outcome landed inside their range

One row per anonymous ECB forecaster (64 of them, sorted best at the top), one column per year. Each said where euro-area inflation would land with 80% confidence. **Green** = it did. **Red** = it did not. Grey = not on the panel that year.

■ inside their range ■ missed ■ not on the panel



The columns are the story: in 2008, and again through 2021–2023, not one of the 64 was inside the range they themselves had published. The rows are the other story: some are green far more often than others — but the best of them still quotes a wider range.

Data: ECB Survey of Professional Forecasters, individual responses, one-year-ahead (Q4 round of the year before) vs euro-area HICP, 10+ scored years each. Forecasters are anonymous; the ECB publishes them only by number. · method and every number: namikakmandev.github.io/ecb-forecaster-skill.html

ECB Survey of Professional Forecasters · euro area · 2000–2025

I work in pricing.

Every plan I build rests on an inflation forecast.

Every quarter the ECB asks about 50 banks and research institutes across Europe where inflation will land, and how sure they are about it.

In 2022 it came in at 8.4%. Of the 58 who answered that round, not one had it inside their range.

So I went back and scored all 26 years, one forecaster at a time.

The promise you can check

The ECB does not just ask for a number. It asks each institution for a range they are **80% sure** about.

That is a promise with a test attached. If you say 80%, then over 20 years the answer should land inside your range about 16 times.

64

forecasters with 10+ scored
years

1,184

forecasts scored

26

years followed, one by one

These are outside institutions, not the ECB's own staff projections. The ECB publishes panellists only by number; nothing here identifies any of them.

Read it down the columns

**2008, 2021, 2022 and
2023**

In each of those years, **not one** forecaster on the panel contained the outcome.

And they were all wrong the same way. **178 forecasts across those four years, 178 underestimates, zero overestimates.** When this panel fails completely, it does not see costs coming.

Not a one-way record overall: across all 26 years 65% of misses were too low and 35% too high. It is the total failures that are one-sided.

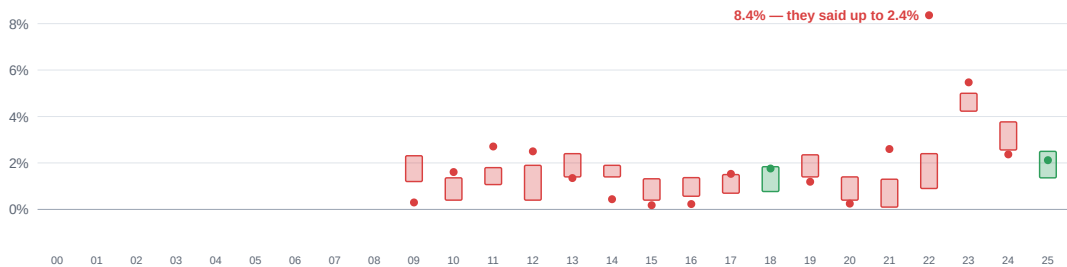
What a miss looks like — ECB panel, euro-area inflation, 2000–2025

Each bar is the range one forecaster published for that year's euro-area inflation — the middle 80% of what they thought possible. The dot is what inflation actually did. Dot inside the bar = **a hit**. Dot outside = **a miss**. A year with no bar is a year they were not on the panel.

Forecaster #016 — the best of the panel: inside its own range 19 years out of 25



Forecaster #101 — the worst of the panel: inside its own range 2 years out of 17



Both were wrong about 2022. The difference is that #016 publishes ranges wide enough to be right the rest of the time.

Data: ECB Survey of Professional Forecasters, individual responses, one-year-ahead (Q4 round of the year before), vs euro-area HICP. Forecasters are anonymous; the ECB publishes them only by number. · method and every number: namikakmandev.github.io/ecb-forecaster-skill.html

Across the rows they are not interchangeable: best to worst is **57 percentage points**, far too wide to be luck.

But a range can be right just by being huge. The best forecaster's ranges are **2.5× wider** than the worst's, and width alone explains **47%** of the score.

What to do with it

“Costs will rise 0–10%” is almost never wrong and almost never useful. So score a forecast twice, not once:

1. How often the outcome fell inside the stated range.
2. How wide that range had to be to manage it.

The first number can be bought. Only the second tells you whether they know anything.

1 of 64

hit their own 80% standard. Not my standard — theirs.

And that one was off the panel for 2021, 2022, 2023. Of the forecasters who actually faced the hard years, none held to the confidence they had published.

Method, every number and the full script:

namikakmandev.github.io/ecb-forecaster-skill.html

Data: ECB Survey of Professional Forecasters, published openly.